ARUN SHARMA

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WORK EXPERIENCE

POCKETFM *Aug'25-Feb'26*

- Early Strategy & Growth leadership team of PocketFM's micro-drama vertical; scaled to **$1.5M MRR, 500K DAU** in 4 months
- **Led 40-member cross-functional team** to conceive and deploy "Promo Cracking Engine", collaborated with engineering on tool scoping, sequencing, & milestone tracking; drove 50% increase in paid spend efficiency across 20+ shows
- Owned Content Marketing for PocketTV, scaled Instagram, YouTube & FB Channels to 500M+ organic views & Ad-revenue to 15K$ /month
- Setup 30-member Indian Commissioning & Content Editorial team for PocketFM US's flagship category Romantasy-$50M ARR

INSURANCEDEKHO (CarDekho Group) *Aug'23-Jul'25*

Senior Associate Director/ Chief of Staff

- **Central Projects**
  - Led **AOP exercises** & Competitive Product Benchmarking, Crafted launch playbook - adopted for 50+ high ROI city scale-up
  - Owned onboarding funnel optimization, weekly business & monthly P&L reviews; established goal-setting frameworks and performance reporting structures across 1500+ member sales team with OKR focus to 50 CXO-2 level
- **Biz & Ops Head,** Cross-Sell
  - **CEO Reporting & Accelerated promotion**: Built profitable cross-sell business from scratch, scaling to **₹100+ Cr AGWP & ~15Cr ARR** for 4 high-margin product lines. Drove sharp AOP adherence, daily ops, weekly funnel reviews, & monthly GM tracking
  - Led P&L & Ops strategy of **75+ member** execution team (60+ Sales & Ops, 5+ Biz, 5+ Tech) while collaborating with central teams
  - Owned product & marketing strategy- integrated recommendation engine to empower partner agents with personalized suggestions

Associate Director, Founder's Office

- **Biz & Ops Head,** *Category-Financial Services*
  - Led -1->0->1 bet of **Digital-First lending** (CCs & PLs) via **200K+ agents** in PoSP model through 3 vendors with 12+ Banks & NBFCs
  - Developed minimum viable strategy for expanding into Investment products (FDs, Mutual fund) & secured loans via B2B2C
  - **Supply Acquisition Strategy:** Revamped & executed multi-channel agent acquisition strategy, onboarding 6K+ Channels monthly to scale from 80K->200K (via 4K-Digital,1K-referral, 1K-Sales-led); Led 20+ executives to optimize onboarding funnel & TAT

MPL (Mobile Premier League) *May'21-Aug'23*

Chief of Staff & Strategy Lead, Mayhem Studios

- **Series A Fund Raise**
  - **Led Spin-off & Closed 20 Mn$ Series A** round from Tier 1 VCs (incl. Sequoia Capital, True-caller, Hashed, Stead View Capital) solely with CEO; Participated in Investor pitches to 150+ global funds, landing 10+ Investment Committee meetings
  - Early team member - Owned investor tracker, pitch-deck, VDR, Product demos, MIS & Due-diligence (Financial & Technical)
- **GTM Strategy**
  - Secured GTM & distribution partnership with **Truecaller**; Closed onboarding & project deals with 10+/80 global gaming studios
  - **PMO Projects**: 8-week Alpha playtesting strategy & plan, Community outreach, Content-Marketing & modelling Web3 Monetization

Manager, Strategy & Biz Ops

- Owned **org-wide OKR design** & **led Quarterly Roadmap Planning (QRP)** across 10+ engineering and product PODs; translated technical delivery milestones into executive narratives for CEO/CXO decision-making each quarter
- Led **end-to-end technical program management for IPL Fantasy** (1.7M+ DAU); built 10+ cross-functional dashboards to track engineering milestones, surface dependencies, and drive daily prioritization across business and tech teams
- Executed data-driven digital **CLM strategy**, improving stickiness (D7/D30 retention +7%/3%) & monetization (+15% LTV, ROAS)
- Forecasted workforce allocation for FY22 by formulating a gap analysis for 20+ teams; Executed 30% efficiency in Tech-Hiring

BCG (Boston Consulting Group) *Mar'20-May'20*

- Reimagined post-COVID GCC's Strategy via in-depth interviews of 10+ CEOs, Influencing 3000+ executives at 2 NASSCOM conferences
- Led primary research initiative to build GCC roadmaps in pandemic-driven shifts in digital, talent, & cost optimization in IT sector

NOVARTIS *Jul'17-May'19*

- **Accelerated promotion** for delineating scalable segmentation framework to target 60k+ physicians in 14 US States using **SAS & SQL**
- Led global data lake transformation as Key Indian POC, saving 40% Manhours by moving to **Alteryx, Power BI & Tableau**
- Awarded **Quarterly Best project award** for designing one-stop solution for Global CXOs to monitor & sales strategize $1B+ cardio drug

EDUCATION

IIM CALCUTTA MBA *2019-2021*

- **Institute Rank 20/480** (Term-4 SGPA 8/9); Top 10%ile in batch; CAT'18- 99.72%ile, GMAT-99%ile equivalent
- National Runners Up/5000+ teams in Accenture B-School Challenge; X-Cultural Project Winner (1/5000+ International teams)

NITK, SURATHKAL B.Tech *2013-2017*

- **Silver Medalist 2nd/100 Rank (9.2/10)**; XII – 93%| X – CGPA 10 | JEE AIR – 4922, "Best Outgoing student"
- MITACS (International Internship): Granted scholarship - 1/500 International students, 1/15 students from NITK

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- **Chief of Staff**: Origin: Accel backed Physical-AI Startup for US Construction *Dec'25-Mar'26*
  - **End to End ownership of raising Series-A fund;** Owned VDR, Investor demos, board presentations, FAQs & GTM strategy
  - Setup Company wide-OKRs, hackathons & built a team from 0 to 20 member across GTM, Deployment, HR & Marketing function
- **Activities:** Trekked to **Mt. Everest Base Camp(5364m) &** three 5000+ mts peaks; State Level Basketball player
- **Interests**: AI-Native practitioner**,** Avid Non-fiction reader; Recognized Growth-X Fellow & deep interest in Indian VC ecosystem